Project Charter: Sauce & Spoon Menu Tablet Pilot

DATE: 12/10/2026

Context: *Sauce & Spoon is a small restaurant chain that wants to meet its annual growth and expansion goals. As one way to meet these goals, they've decided to launch a pilot project to* ***test out the impact of installing new tabletop menu tablets****. The new menu tablets will allow the restaurant to serve more guests in less time and will also provide valuable data that will help Sauce & Spoon meet its business goals.*

The company just hired Peta as their first in-house project manager to oversee the tablet rollout. To get started on the project charter, Peta spends some time reviewing the documents provided by Sauce & Spoon and meets with some of the project's stakeholders to get familiar with the project and the company.

Project Summary

Sauce & Spoon will launch a pilot of tabletop menu tablets in the bar area of two restaurant locations, Sauce & Spoon North and Sauce & Spoon Downtown. Guests will be able to order and pay without waiting for a server, and the tablets will promote add-on items with coupons. This will speed up service, turn tables more quickly, and serve more guests. It will also give us clear data points to track metrics and decide on any wider rollout.

Project Goals

SMART: Specific, Measurable, Attainable, Relevant, and Time-bound

1. Decrease average table turn time in the bar area by 30 minutes (from about 80 to about 50 minutes) by the end of Q2.
2. Increase average daily guest count by 10% by the end of Q2.
3. Decrease food waste and send-back comps by 25% from the pre-pilot baseline by the end of Q2.
4. Increase appetizer sales by TBD% by the end of Q2 (proposed: +10% at North and +20% at Downtown, pending approval).

5. Increase average check total from $65 to at least $75 by the end of Q2.
6. Decrease customer checkout time by TBD% by the end of Q2.
7. Achieve TBD% customer satisfaction in the pilot, measured by a post-dining survey, and reduce negative reviews citing "delay in service."

Deliverables

1. Installation of working tablets in the bar area at two restaurant locations
2. Tablet package with promotion of specific menu items as add-ons and coupons for those items
3. Integration with the current Point of Sale (POS) and host systems, including sending guest modifications to the kitchen
4. Upgrade of wiring, electrical, and WiFi systems, as needed
5. Training of management, FOH staff, and BOH staff
6. Hiring of additional BOH staff as necessary, starting with two part-time line cooks
7. Promotion of the tablet menu pilot via table signs and email blasts
8. Implementation of a post-dining survey to assess customer satisfaction
9. Baseline data and tracking of pilot metrics

Scope and Exclusion

In-Scope: Tablet implementation in the bar area of two locations (including POS and host integration, menu design, and customization), upgrade of wiring and WiFi, training, hiring of additional staff as necessary, marketing promotion, post-dining survey, and IT maintenance through the end of the year.

Out-of-Scope: Order return and meal replacement policy changes (to be handled as an operations item), improving kitchen staff satisfaction (until an agreed way to measure it exists), and rollout beyond the bar areas (any expansion will be decided after the pilot).

Benefits & Costs

Benefits:

- Improve service times, leading to happier customers
- Improve the rate of correct orders, leading to happier customers
- Serve more guests and sell more per guest, increasing total revenue
- Reduce food waste and remade orders

- Clear data points to track metrics and inform a decision on expansion

Costs:
- Training materials and fees ($10,000)
- Hardware and software implementation ($30,000)
- IT fees/Maintenance through EOY ($5,000)
- Updated website and menu design ($5,000)
- Customization ($550)

Budget needed: $50,550
Not included in the quote: additional staff and wiring, electrical, and WiFi upgrades [TBD].

Appendix:

Misalignments and Decisions:
- Misalignment: Carter assumed an order return policy change was part of the tablet project; Gilly had not agreed to it.
- Decision: Policy changes are not tied to this project. They are an operations item for Deanna and Carter to discuss, and Peta will update the goals if a change is adopted.

- Misalignment: Carter and Alex wanted order return and meal replacement policy changes in the charter; Gilly and Peta wanted them handled separately.
- Decision: Policy changes will be handled outside the tablet rollout. Gilly is willing to discuss but is not committing to any change.

- Misalignment: Carter wanted a goal to improve kitchen staff satisfaction; Peta did not know how to measure it.
- Decision: It will not be included until Carter and Peta agree on a way to measure it.

- Misalignment: Food waste is not the only reason for the return policy concern; Carter's kitchen also performs worse against its food wait time metrics when it is busy and remaking orders.
- Decision: The food waste goal will be adjusted to better capture kitchen performance, with metrics to come from Carter [TBD].

- Misalignment: Alex wanted a 20% appetizer sales increase; Gilly thought the tablets would have little impact at North and suggested cutting the goal.
- Decision: Keep the goal at TBD%. Proposed targets are +10% at North and +20% at Downtown, pending Deanna's approval.

- Misalignment: Alex and Deanna wanted to reallocate front-of-house payroll to hire kitchen staff; Gilly did not want to give up FOH payroll, and Peta noted there is no data yet on the savings.
- Decision: Hiring additional staff is in scope as necessary, starting with two part-time line cooks. Any reallocation of FOH payroll will be decided from pilot data. Gilly's agreement is still to be confirmed.

Other decision:
The goal to decrease guest wait time was removed because faster table turn times reduce the time guests wait for a table.

Open items:
- Confirm whether the $30,000 implementation cost covers only the two pilot locations.
- Collect baselines for guest count, food waste and comps, appetizer sales, average check, and checkout time.
- Confirm the evaluation period: end of Q2 (per the team meeting) or EOY (per the cost sheet).